Dear Hiring Team at Halden Pay,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. I have nine years of experience building and operating data platforms across payments and other data-intensive businesses, with hands-on work in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka, and cloud warehouses. Halden Pay's focus on reusable platform capabilities is a strong match for the work I have done and the kind of engineering I enjoy.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I design, build, and operate the ingestion layer of a production data platform, with around 140 Airflow DAGs feeding Snowflake. I migrated transformation logic into more than 420 dbt models with tests, reducing nightly runtime from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I also introduced JSON Schema data contracts with CI checks, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine per month to two and giving product and data teams clearer quality standards. I have also introduced data contracts with CI checks, built a Kafka event pipeline processing around 30 million events a day, and contributed fixes and tests to an open-source Airflow provider. These projects reflect my focus on reliable, reusable systems and practical improvements to how teams work with data.

Earlier, at Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile about 1.2 TB of settlement files per day, reducing month-end manual reconciliation from around three days to four hours. I also designed a Redshift dimensional (star-schema) warehouse with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk, and built large-scale batch processing on AWS EMR for approximately 1.2 TB of settlement files per day, and added data quality checks to critical finance tables. Alongside this production experience, I hold an AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate certification and an MSc in Computer Science.

I would welcome the opportunity to bring my production data-platform, dimensional data-modelling, data-quality, and open-source experience to Halden Pay's Data Platform team and help build dependable shared capabilities for its analysts, data scientists, and product teams. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm